24. Retirement benefit obligations continued

Post-employment benefit obligations disclosures
The amounts charged to the Consolidated income statement are set out below:

	2019 £m	2018 £m
Past service cost	**0.4**	–
Total amounts charged to the Consolidated income statement	**0.4**	–

On 26 October 2018, the High Court handed down a judgment involving the Lloyds Banking Group's defined benefit pension schemes. The judgment concluded the schemes should be amended to equalise pension benefits for men and women in relation to guaranteed minimum pension (GMP) benefits for the effect of unequal GMPs accrued between 1990 and 1997. The issues determined by the judgment affect many other UK defined benefit pension schemes. We are working with the trustee of our pension scheme, and our actuarial and legal advisors, to understand the extent to which the judgment crystallises additional liabilities for the pension scheme.

The true impact of GMP equalisation on the Scheme will not be known until members' benefits have been rectified, which could take over a year. However, we understand that it is necessary under the relevant accounting standard to make allowance for the estimated impact of GMP equalisation as at the date of the judgment.

The estimated impact of the equalisation of GMP benefits has been recognised in the income statement as a past service cost. This amounted to an increase in liabilities of £0.4m as at 26 October 2018 which has been included in the pension scheme liability at 31 March 2019.

Current service costs and past service costs are charged to the income statement in arriving at Operating profit. Interest income on Scheme assets and the interest cost on Scheme liabilities are included within finance costs.

In addition, the following amounts have been recognised in the Consolidated statement of comprehensive income:

	2019 £m	2018 £m
Return on Scheme assets (in excess of) / below that recognised in net interest	**(0.9)**	–
Actuarial losses / (gains) losses due to changes in assumptions	**0.3**	(1.0)
Actuarial (gains) / losses due to liability experience	**(0.5)**	0.1
Effect of the surplus cap	**0.9**	0.9
Total amounts recognised within Consolidated statement of comprehensive income	**(0.2)**	–

Amounts recognised in the balance sheet are as follows:

	2019 £m	2018 £m
Present value of funded obligations	**20.0**	19.7
Fair value of plan assets	**(22.2)**	(21.0)
Effect of surplus cap	**2.2**	1.3
Net asset recognised in the Consolidated balance sheet	**–**	–

The surplus of £2.2m (2018: £1.3m) has not been recognised as an asset as it is not deemed to be recoverable by the Group.

Movements in the fair value of Scheme assets were as follows:

	2019 £m	2018 £m
Fair value of Scheme assets at the beginning of the year	**21.0**	21.4
Interest income on Scheme assets	**0.5**	0.5
Remeasurement gains on Scheme assets	**1.0**	–
Contributions by the employer	**0.1**	0.1
Net benefits paid	**(0.4)**	(1.0)
Fair value of Scheme assets at the end of the year	**22.2**	21.0